POCAR 2027 Instructions

January 15th-18th, 2027

Welcome to POCAR 2027 in Brown County State Park. The following are instructions for this year's race. Some of this will be a repeat of what was on our registration website and some of it will be updated information. Even if you've already read through all of that, give this a brief look over to make sure you did not miss anything.

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Important Note for 2027 Event

This note is important, so it is in red. Brown County State Park had a tornado touch down on May 16, 2025. It cut a path nearly 2000 ft wide through the southern part of the park, bringing down every tree. This area is dangerous to attempt to cross, and is considered **out of bounds**. It will be clearly marked on the map. There are trails that pass through this area which are passable, and will also be marked on the map. No points will be placed in or near this damage area. Roads through the damaged area are navigable and in bounds.

Race Information

The Purdue Outing Club Adventure Race (POCAR) is a 48-hour orienteering race held over Martin Luther King weekend in Southern Indiana. This year's race will be held in Brown County State Park. The race will begin at 10:00 a.m., January 16, 2027 and end by 10:30 a.m., January 18, 2027. Teams will be given UTM coordinates for checkpoints, and must be able to plot their own points. Make sure that there are at least 1 or 2 people on your team that can do this – no assistance will be provided on the day of the race! Volunteers will be constantly patrolling predetermined roads during the race in case a team is lost, hurt, or decides to drop out of the race.

On race day, teams are given a list of checkpoints with unique UTM coordinates. Teams must plot each UTM coordinate on the provided topographical maps, and navigate to each checkpoint to complete the race. The team that visits all required checkpoints in the least amount of time wins the race.

At each checkpoint will be an Orienteering Control Flag 12 inches or larger. All flags are attached to a 360 ring of reflective tape, a unique card-punch, and an ID code. The reflective tape will assist locating flags after dark by reflecting light from a headlamp. The ID code allows racers and course setters to confirm the checkpoint, and the unique punch allows race officials to confirm that each team has visited each control flag. Make sure the ID code for each control flag matches the ID code on your team's punch card!

Please be aware that not all checkpoints may be required to complete the race. In the past, decoy control flags have been placed on the course; new checkpoints have been revealed late in the race and some checkpoints must be completed in a particular order. Be ready for anything!

Driving Directions for Brown County State Park

Recreation Building Shelter is located in Brown County State Park about forty five minutes East of Bloomington, half an hour West of Columbus (IN), and fifteen minutes south of Nashville (IN).

From Bloomington, Indiana

Travel east via IN-46 E for 15 miles to W Gate Entrance Rd. Turn right onto W Gate Entrance Rd. and continue for 5 miles. The road becomes Horseman Camp Rd, then Parkview Ln, then you arrive at the Recreation Building Shelter on your right.

From Columbus, Indiana

Take IN-46 W for 16 miles past Gnaw Bone to Brown County State Park Rd. on your left. Follow Brown County State Park Rd. for 4 miles following signs for Rally Campground or Buffalo Ridge Campground. Recreation Building Shelter will be on your right.

From Nashville, Indiana

Travel east via IN-135 for 2 miles, then enter the park at the entrance to your right. Continue on Brown County State Park Rd for 4 miles, following signs for Rally Campground or Buffalo Ridge Campground. Recreation Building Shelter will be on your right.

Camping and Parking

The park has an entrance fee. Depending on what time you arrive, you may be required to pay. Gate staff typically leave at 6pm or 7pm and come back at 9am or 10am. You can enter without paying when the gate is unstaffed. Cars cost $7 for in-state plates, and $15 for out-of-state plates.

Teams can camp and park at the Rally Camp parking lot or County Store parking lot. Parking is also available at a lot to the East of Buffalo Ridge Campground. All parking options are under a minute walk to HQ. The Recreation Building Shelter will be used as the HQ for the race officials and both the volunteer and racer campground. If you arrive on Friday, January 15th, pop in and say hi to the race officials at headquarters in the Recreation Building Shelter just so we know you're there. See the itinerary section for details of what to expect on race day. . Be prepared for possible snowy and icy conditions on the roads within the forest depending on the weather leading up to the weekend. BCSP plows their roads, but surrounding roads may be unmaintained, and heavy snowfall may cause issues. Allow extra time traveling to and from the race.

Itinerary

Friday, January 15

Teams arriving early should report to the Recreation Building Shelter

Saturday, January 16

8 am- 9:30 am	Check-in at the campsite HQ - teams receive maps, UTM plotters, safety vests, and racer packets. There will be a table for open teams and one for collegiate teams. Ensure you are in the right line for an easier and quicker check in process!
9:30 am	**MANDATORY** pre-race meeting. All racers must attend.
10:00 am	Race start for Open Division (estimated)
10:30 am	Race start for Collegiate Division (estimated)

When teams report for their respective start times they will receive a sealed envelope containing a list of checkpoints. At the appropriate start times, teams will then be allowed to open the envelope and begin the race. To make sure all teams can start on time, please report 15 minutes before your start time (as indicated) so that the appropriate materials can be handed out in a timely fashion.

Monday, January 18

10:00 am (estimated)	Race ends for Open Division
10:30 am (estimated)	Race ends for Collegiate Division

Note that race end times will be exactly 48h after that division started. If we end up starting open division at 10:13am Saturday, the race will end for open division at 10:13am Monday.

Course Information

The race will begin and end at the Recreation Building Shelter in Brown County State Park. This year's course is **over** 30 miles as the crow flies and consists of 3 legs. Teams are divided into two race divisions: Open and Collegiate, with respective start times of 10:00 am and 10:30 am. 15 minutes prior to the start times each team must report to the starting area where they will receive a sealed envelope containing a punch card for the first leg along with a list of all checkpoints, though all coordinates may not be available at this time. The envelope must remain sealed until instructed to open by the race director at race start.

Once teams have visited each checkpoint and punched the appropriate space on the punch card from the first leg, they should return to the Shelter HQ where the first leg punches will be verified by race officials. The punch card will be collected, checked, and teams will be issued their punch card for the second leg. The process is the same when finishing the second and third leg. Upon completion of the race, or if dropping out (see official rules section on dropping out), all racers must return to the Shelter HQ where officials will verify the completed punches and collect the punch card. Even if teams only complete a portion of a leg, the punch card must be turned in to race officials, as it will be used to tabulate race results. Teams may be required to

stop at a specific F/W station during completion on any given leg. Failure to check out, whether finishing the race or dropping out, will result in disqualification and potentially denied admission to future POCAR events.

Registration Information

A team will be officially registered once we have received payment and signed waivers from at least four members of a team. It is the responsibility of the team to ensure that all team members have filled out forms and have paid their respective registration fees. Registration will be done through IMLeagues, and payment will be collected through TooCOOL. IMLeagues does not allow a team to be fully registered until payment and paperwork are done.

Open Division vs. Collegiate Division

There are two divisions, and therefore there is a winner from each division. An open division team is considered any team that has any non-student on the team. A student is anyone currently enrolled in college (does not have to be Purdue). If any member of your team is not currently a student, then the entire team races in the Open Division. If every member of your team is a student then your team is in the Collegiate Division. Note that no matter what division your team is a part of, you still pay the amount for the division you individually fit into.

Short summary: If every team member is currently a college student, then you race as a Collegiate team. Otherwise, you race as an Open team.

Cancellation Policy

Please note that there are no refunds for this event in case of cancellation before or during the race, or if you drop out, before or during the race.

Rules

Racers are responsible for reading the rules as outlined in “POCAR 2027 Race Rules.” Failure to abide by the rules will result in disqualification from the race.

Note that the rule sheet contains a list of required items. These items *must* be on the team at all times during the race. Random checks to ensure that the team has these items will be conducted. Failure to display these required items will result in disqualification.

Emergency Contact during Race

In case of an emergency and a racer’s family needs to reach the team in the midst of the race, they can call one of the coordinators. Note that this procedure should be used in case of

emergency ONLY, and that racers are responsible for providing this information to their family before the race. Cell service in the forest is not reliable, so immediate response is not guaranteed. If the coordinator doesn't have service, family members are to leave the following information in the form of a voicemail or text message: team member name, the message that they are trying to deliver, and their information to call them back. Coordinators will occasionally be able to get service, in which case they will notify all volunteers and teams to look for the racer, and the racer and their team will be taken back to HQ to respond to the emergency.

This procedure will take time. The remoteness of the location is part of the nature of the race. Although reliable plans are in place to be able to contact emergency medical services in case of a medical emergency, it is not possible at the time to provide a convenient and fast method of contacting the teams.

Phone numbers:

Micah Robinson, Race Coordinator	(650) 709-6395
Kerby Midy, Registration Coordinator	(332) 279-8581
Keira Murphy, Volunteer Coordinator	(812) 340-7075

Contact Information

The primary contact used by coordinators is: pocarcoordinators@gmail.com

If you have any questions about racing, contact the race coordinator, *Micah Robinson*, at: robin709@purdue.edu

If you have questions about registration, contact the registration coordinator, *Kerby Midy*, at: kmidy@purdue.edu

If you have questions about volunteering, contact the volunteer coordinator, *Keira Murphy*, at: murph636@purdue.edu